

Richard Strauss in Germany and Gustav Mahler in Austria, but when *Pelleas* was premiered in 1905 it drew derision from both critics and public.

“ If it is art, it is not for all, and if it is for all, it is not art. ”

ARNOLD SCHOENBERG, *STYLE AND IDEA*, 1946

In 1901, Schoenberg married Mathilde Zemlinsky, the sister of his friend Alexander. The couple had two children. Dividing his time between Berlin and Vienna, he supported his family via musical odd jobs, including teaching composition. Meanwhile, his own compositions developed in an increasingly radical direction. His Chamber Symphony of 1906 replaced the Romantic large-scale orchestra by a spare ensemble of 15 players. In a series of works between 1907 and 1909, including the song cycle *The Book of the Hanging Gardens* and the *Five Orchestral Pieces*, he moved toward the total abandonment of tonality. With no tonic chord to ground the music, a rootless sound-world emerged, expressive of alienation.

Schoenberg's technical innovations were fueled by heightened emotion at a troubled period in his life. Tempted to explore painting—at which he proved gifted enough to exhibit with the avant-garde *Der Blaue Reiter* group in 1911—he became friends with a young artist, Richard Gerstl. But in 1908, Schoenberg's wife ran off with Gerstl. After a few months, she returned to her